

Before you ever give out information about your card to another company, insist on a complete set of references and information about the company and the product before actually revealing your details.

If you receive unsolicited calls from people claiming to be your credit card service provider and request for your account number, never give it. If the caller is indeed from your service provider, they would already know your details. In case of a doubt, ask the caller to notate on your file and call back on the number given at the back of your credit card and cross-check.

What's in a name?

While in Shakespearean era this would just be another argument, in our existence, your identity is as important as your bank details. Once stolen, your well-being can be seriously compromised. In 2008 alone, there were 10 million cases of identity theft worldwide in the US. More people are now adept at identifying attempts at identity theft. However, prevention still remains the best solution and you can do that by following the solutions given below.

Choose a strong password for your details. This should be so strong that people should not be able to guess it. You can use a simple cipher like the Vignere Cipher for this purpose. The internet will offer randomly generated passwords that can be unbreakable. Never use phone numbers or your vehicle numbers. And, add a capital letter to add strength to your passwords.

Be wary of people at the ATM or the supermarket, especially the types that look over your shoulder. While appearing uninterested or innocent, they might be sneakily observing your PIN details or your account balance. Ensure that you cover the monitor with your hand before keying in the important information. Even when there is nobody around, follow this practice as most people use binoculars or cameras to capture this data from far away.

Old billing statements and other documents should never be thrown in the dustbin. Instead, shred it carefully as there are people who would go through the dustbins in search of such incriminating information. Investing in a cross cut paper shredder that will completely destroy any piece of paper is actually a good idea. Ensure that the shredder doesn't just create strips of paper that can easily be patched up together. Instead, use a device that does a thorough job and for an extra measure, dump one half of the bill in one garbage bag will disposing the rest in another one. This may sound overcautious but it's better to be safe than sorry.